

has a dismal 1 per cent share of the global art market, could look at a staggering \$400 million in the decade or so, in a world market that will be valued at \$30 billion. "Compared to international art, Indian art is considered cheap. I can get very good Indian works for \$30,000-\$40,000, where as I'd have to spend at least \$1million for a good work from Europe or America."

Comparisons between India and China were at the forefront of the discussions. Leading artist Anjolie Ela Menon says China has managed to find appeal among global collectors, rais-

cent higher than it was five years ago in the European Circuit. Hoffman predicts that an Andy Warhol and a Husain might in the near future be priced equally. With Sotheby's bringing Damien Hirst's works to India and the Nandalal Bose Retrospective opening in Philadelphia at the same time, it can be safely be concluded that India has made its mark in the world of art.

More than buyers and sellers, it was the enthusiasm shown by the art community that made the Art Summit an exciting destination. "Currently, there is no clarity on how Indian art

should be developed and most of the events are managed by private galleries, which is why I hope a summit like this can be a guiding force for everybody," said veteran artist Krishen Khanna. The only sour note was the decision to withdraw the works of Husain from the summit. "It is these very private galleries that have made crores of rupees over the years, thanks to Husain," says art critic Geeta Kapur.

The summit represented a much-needed reality check for the Indian art industry; firstly, by exposing how fragile and without foundation the Indian



FOREIGN FLAVOUR: British artist Will Martyr with his India focus collection at the summit

"Art is the new luxury. It's not just a collectible but an investible."

PHILLIP HOFFMAN, FINE ART FUND

ing the price of Chinese art globally. Chinese-Americans recently raised over a million dollars to participate at the world museum show, while the Indian diaspora could barely manage \$50,000. While the big four names in Indian art continue to be Tyeb Mehta, F.N. Souza, S.H. Raza and M.F. Husain with Mehta's work fetching a record breaking \$1.58 million at Christie's auction and Souza's selling for \$1.36 million at Sotheby's. Younger artists like Subodh Gupta are expected to herald the sunrise industry that is Indian art. Some Indian artists command a value that is nearly 400 per



art market was; secondly, in its decision to withdraw the works of Husain, which showed where the artist community stood vis-a-vis freedom of expression in a democracy, and finally, what they could (or not) expect from the state. Yet, with preparations having already begun for the 2009 summit, which the organisers say will be three times bigger, "in participation and in scale", one can safely say that while it's not Art Basel yet, the India Art Summit is certainly a step in the right direction for Indian art. Like Menon concludes, "Finally, all great art is about art."